

KSBL • ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOUR • FALL 2026

CHECKOUT

REDESIGNING THE CHECKOUT CASHIER ROLE

USING THE JOB CHARACTERISTICS MODEL
CHECKOUT CASHIERS • IMTIAZ STORES • KARACHI

a field study

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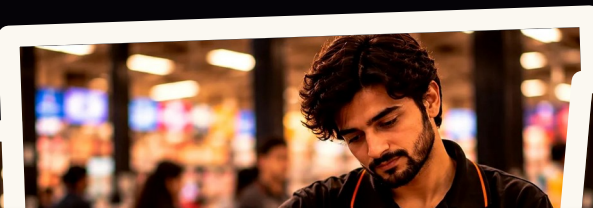
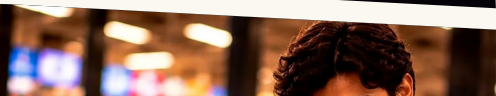
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THE LAST PERSON YOU MEET.

CHECKOUT

MONEY	✓
DISCOUNTS	✓
ACCURACY	✓
WAITING TIME	✓

= FINAL IMPRESSION



AGAIN.

**FOR AN ENTIRE
SHIFT.**



**CAN A JOB BE
IMPORTANT
AND STILL BE POORLY
DESIGNED?**

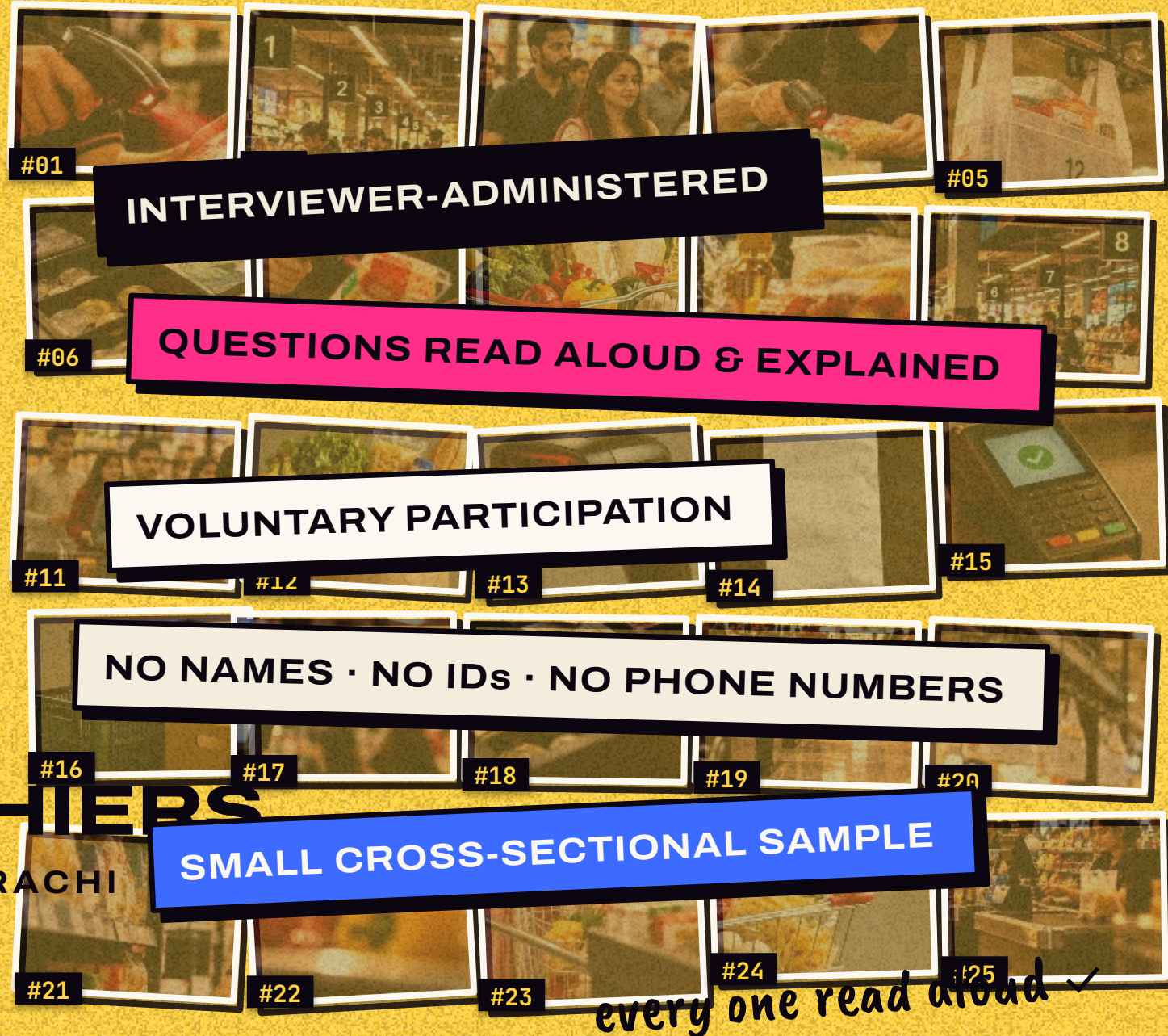
**WE ASKED
THE
CASHIERS**



25

CHECKOUT CASHIERS

MULTIPLE IMTIAZ BRANCHES · KARACHI



FIVE JOB CHARACTERISTICS

Job Characteristics Model · Hackman & Oldham (1976)



01
**SKILL
VARIETY**



02
**TASK
IDENTITY**



03
**TASK
SIGNIFICANCE**



04
AUTONOMY



05
FEEDBACK

THE EASY ASSUMPTION

~~repetitive →
job rotation!~~

THEORY BEFORE PROBLEM

DIAGNOSE FIRST.

REDESIGN SECOND.

III REVEAL

MONEY • ACCURACY • THE CUSTOMER

Task Significance

4.09 / 5

START → FINISH

Task Identity

4.04 / 5

CUSTOMER ARRIVES →

SCAN →

PAYMENT →

COMPLETE ✓



III REVEAL

MONEY • ACCURACY • THE CUSTOMER

Task Significance

START → FINISH

Task Identity

MEANING ISN'T THE PROBLEM.

CUSTOMER ARRIVES → SCAN → PAYMENT → COMPLETE ✓

1

2

3

4

5

1 = strongly disagree

5 = strongly agree

TI 4.04

TS 4.09

THE PROBLEM IS SOMEWHERE ELSE.

FEEDBACK

3.40

AUTONOMY

2.84

2.55

OUT OF 5



**SKILL
VARIETY**

lowest of
all five

THE FULL DIAGNOSIS

MEAN SCORE PER JOB CHARACTERISTIC · n = 25 · SCALE 1-5

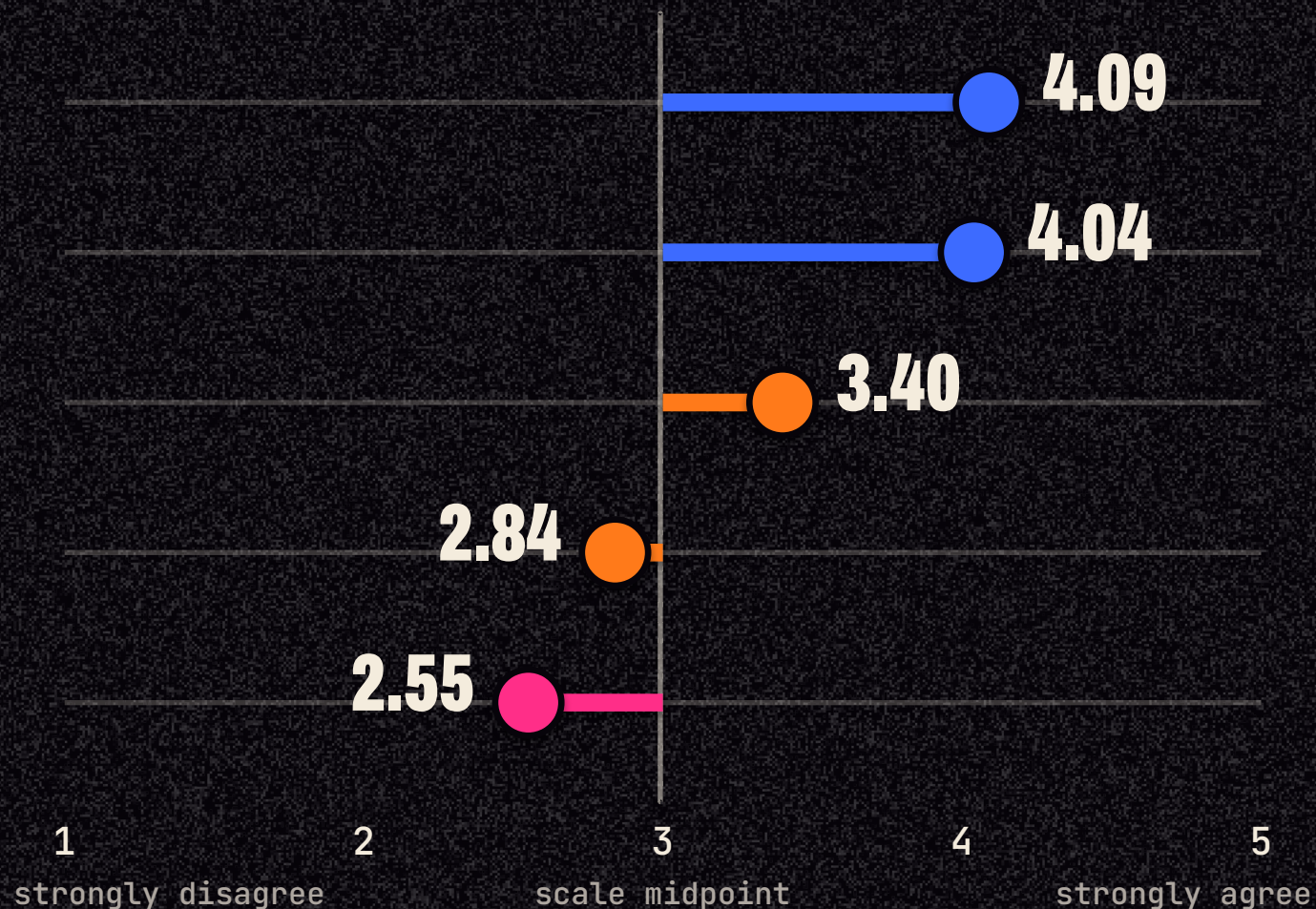
TASK SIGNIFICANCE

TASK IDENTITY

FEEDBACK

AUTONOMY

SKILL VARIETY



A man with dark, curly hair and a beard, wearing a dark chef's uniform with orange trim on the sleeves, is shown from the chest up. He is looking down and to his left with a slight smile. The background is dark and out of focus, with some light flares. The word "MEANINGFUL." is overlaid in large, white, bold, sans-serif capital letters across the center of the image.

MEANINGFUL.

MEANINGFUL.



BUT NARROW.

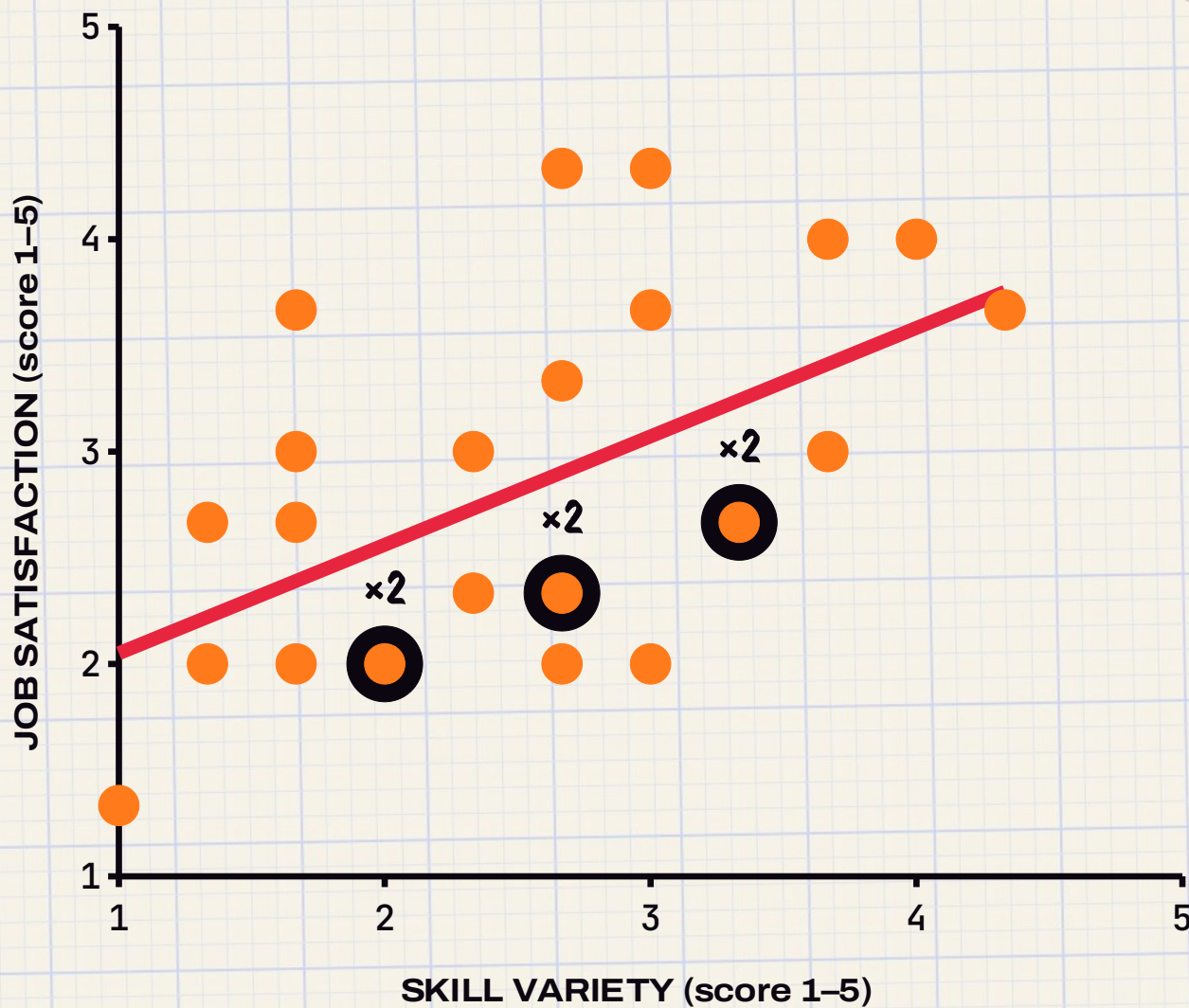


WHAT WOULD CASHIERS VALUE?

Mean agreement • 1-5 • n = 25

~~unlimited freedom~~

~~random movement~~



Each point = one cashier · dashed ring = two cashiers with identical score

$$r \approx .54$$

n = 25 · exploratory · cross-sectional
Skill Variety ↔ Job Satisfaction

**ASSOCIATION
≠ CAUSATION**

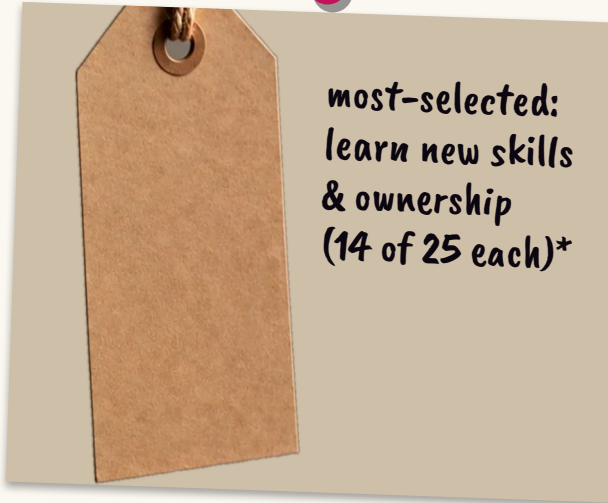
THREE SIGNALS



LOWEST JCM SCORE

2.55

SKILL VARIETY



most-selected:
learn new skills
& ownership
(14 of 25 each)*

WHAT CASHIERS VALUE

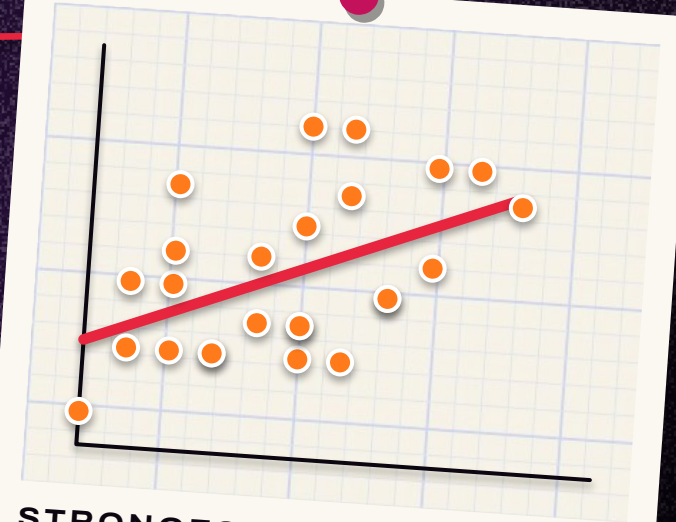
4.32

AUTHORITY

4.16

OWNERSHIP

*exploratory multiple-response item



STRONGEST OBSERVED
ASSOCIATION

$r \approx .54$

SKILL VARIETY ↔ JOB SATISFACTION

THREE SIGNALS



LOWEST SCORE + EMPLOYEE PREFERENCE + STRONGEST ASSOCIATION

MANAGERIAL SIGNAL

– not proof. A reason to redesign carefully and test.



■ Where our data shows the gaps: variety · autonomy · feedback ■ strengths: significance · identity



CHANGE THE JOB,
CHANGE THE EXPERIENCE
OF DOING IT.

VI REDESIGN

PROPOSED REDESIGN

ENRICHED CHECKOUT CASHIER



ENRICHED CHECKOUT CASHIER

01

STRUCTURED MICRO-ROTATION

→ Skill Variety

02

CONTROLLED DECISION AUTHORITY

→ Autonomy

03

CHECKOUT-ZONE OWNERSHIP

→ Responsibility

04

STRUCTURED FEEDBACK

→ Feedback



Keeps what works: Task Identity ✓ · Task Significance ✓ preserved – he still owns the whole transaction

01 · STRUCTURED MICRO-ROTATION

TARGET → Skill Variety



STILL PRIMARILY A CASHIER



**QUEUE
COORDINATION**



**BASIC PRICE-
VERIFICATION
COORDINATION**



**CUSTOMER
CHECKOUT
GUIDANCE**

**ONBOARDING /
SHADOW
SUPPORT**

**CHECKOUT-
AREA
READINESS
CHECKS**

NOT RANDOM MOVEMENT AROUND THE STORE

02 - CONTROLLED DECISION AUTHORITY

TARGET → Autonomy

CURRENT · ROUTINE ISSUES ESCALATE



QUEUE ● ●

PROPOSED · PREDEFINED LOW-RISK ROUTINE ISSUES



HIGH-RISK EXCEPTIONS · SUPERVISOR RETAINS



Significant refunds

Discretionary discounts

Suspected fraud

Security issues

Major price disputes

Unusual exceptions



Proposed design principle – exact permissions & any thresholds would be defined by management.

02 - CONTROLLED DECISION AUTHORITY

TARGET: A Cashier with
Controlled Decision Authority
to resolve customer issues
without escalation.

PROPOSED REDESIGN: A Cashier with
Controlled Decision Authority
to resolve customer issues
without escalation.

CUSTOMER → TRAINED CASHIER → RESOLVED ✓

CASHIER

CUSTOMER

≠

HIGH-RISK EXCEPTIONS - SUPERVISOR RETAINS

UNRESTRICTED
AUTONOMY

Significant refunds

Discretionary discounts

Suspected fraud

Major exceptions

Unusual exceptions



CUSTOMER PROBLEM

TRAINED CASHIER

SUPERVISOR



**MOVE APPROPRIATE DECISIONS
CLOSER TO WHERE THE
CUSTOMER PROBLEM OCCURS.**

03 - CHECKOUT-ZONE OWNERSHIP

TARGET → Responsibility & ownership

JOB ENLARGEMENT

= SIMPLY MORE TASKS



JOB ENRICHMENT

= MORE RESPONSIBILITY & OWNERSHIP



HANDOVER COMMUNICATION



CUSTOMER CONCERNS



CHECKOUT-AREA READINESS



RECURRING POS / PRICING ISSUES



QUEUE BUILDUP

WE AIM FOR ENRICHMENT.

04 - STRUCTURED FEEDBACK

TARGET → Feedback

OPERATIONAL FEEDBACK



did it work? ✓

DEVELOPMENTAL FEEDBACK



am I growing? ↑

04 - STRUCTURED FEEDBACK

TARGET → Feedback

**OPERATIONAL FEEDBACK TELLS YOU
WHETHER THE TRANSACTION WORKED.**

**DEVELOPMENTAL FEEDBACK TELLS YOU
WHETHER YOU ARE GROWING.**

ACCURACY

**CUSTOMER
SERVICE**

RELIABILITY

IMPROVEMENT

RECOGNITION

Short · regular · supervisor-led conversations

**EVERYTHING WE HAVE PROPOSED SO FAR IS
A HYPOTHESIS.**

TEST IT.

PROPOSED - NOT YET CONDUCTED

a plan,
not a result

PROPOSED PILOT • PLAN

6

WEEKS

1

KARACHI
BRANCH

~10-12

CASHIERS

W0

BASELINE

Same JCM, motivation &
satisfaction survey +
operational indicators

W1-6

INTERVENTION

The four proposed changes

W3

MIDPOINT CHECK

Catch operational problems early

W6

POST-MEASUREMENT

Same measures again



EMPLOYEE EXPERIENCE

Skill Variety	expected ↑
Autonomy	expected ↑
Feedback	expected ↑
Internal Work Motivation	expected ↑
Job Satisfaction	expected ↑



OPERATIONAL SAFETY

Transaction / error rate	no worse
Cash discrepancies	no worse
Routine escalations	no worse
Checkout complaints	no worse



EMPLOYEE EXPERIENCE

Skill Variety

expected ↑

Autonomy

expected ↑

Feedback

expected ↑

Internal Work Motivation

expected ↑

Job Satisfaction

expected ↑

NOT A SUCCESS

OPERATIONAL SAFETY

Transaction / error rate

no worse

Cash discrepancies

no worse

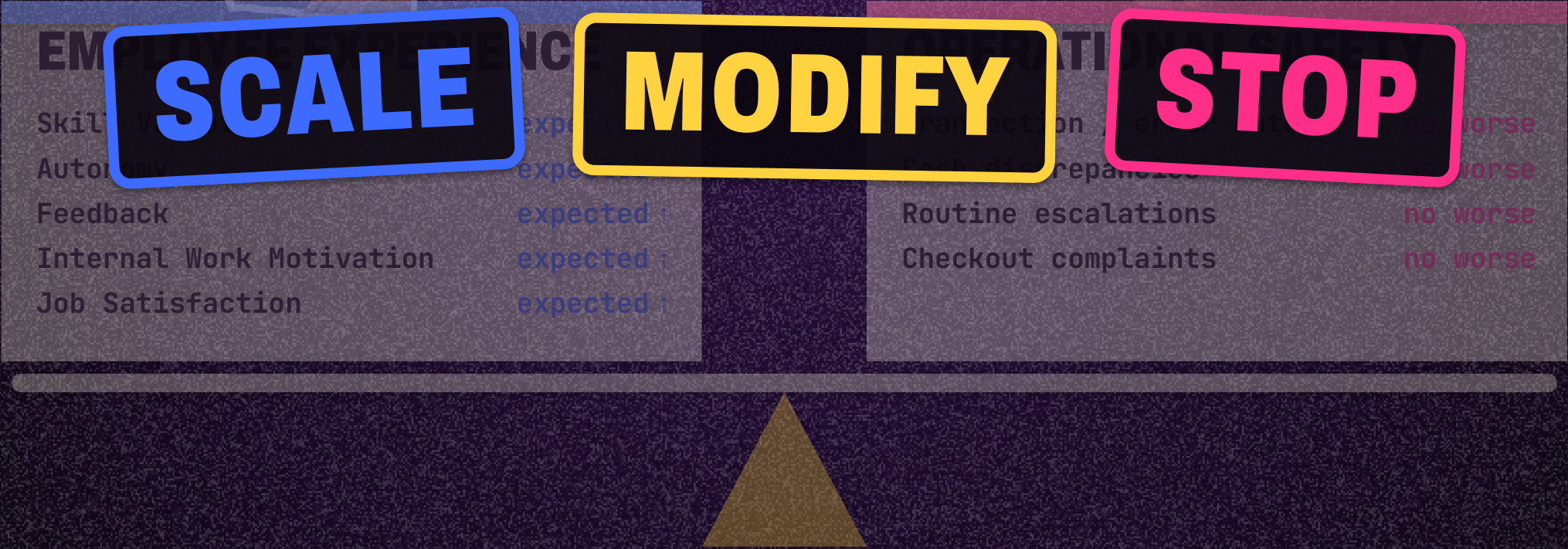
Routine escalations

no worse

Checkout complaints

no worse

HYPOTHETICAL: satisfaction ↑ while cash discrepancies ↑



ROUTINE ≠ MEANINGLESS

ALREADY THERE

- ✓ **TASK SIGNIFICANCE** 4.09
- ✓ **TASK IDENTITY** 4.04

WHAT APPEARS TO BE MISSING

- ❑ **VARIETY**
- ❑ **APPROPRIATE DISCRETION**
- ❑ **DEVELOPMENTAL FEEDBACK**

REDESIGN THE ENVIRONMENT **AROUND** THE CASHIER—NOT THE CASHIER.

ALREADY THERE

- ✓ **TASK SIGNIFICANCE** 4.09
- ✓ **TASK IDENTITY** 4.04

WHAT APPEARS TO BE MISSING

- ☐ **VARIETY**
- ☐ **APPROPRIATE DISCRETION**
- ☐ **DEVELOPMENTAL FEEDBACK**

A JOB SOMEONE PERFORMS...



A JOB SOMEONE OWNS.

01

STRUCTURED
MICRO-ROTATION

02

CONTROLLED
DECISION
AUTHORITY

03

CHECKOUT-ZONE
OWNERSHIP

04

STRUCTURED
FEEDBACK



NOT A DIFFERENT JOB. A BETTER-DESIGNED ONE.

Thank you.

Munhib Alam Khan
Abdullah Khan
Rabie Sami
Karan Kumar

Karachi School of Business & Leadership
Organizational Behaviour · Fall 2026 · Dr. Faryal
Razzaq

Reference: Hackman & Oldham (1976), Organizational
Behavior and Human Performance, 16(2), 250-279.

Photography: AI-generated & illustrative.
No real employees or respondents · not affiliated
with Imtiaz.

EXPLORATORY CORRELATIONS

n = 25 • Pearson r • no significance testing

JOB CHARACTERISTIC	INTERNAL WORK MOTIVATION	JOB SATISFACTION
SKILL VARIETY	+0.312	+0.539
TASK IDENTITY	+0.439	-0.048
TASK SIGNIFICANCE	+0.330	+0.203
AUTONOMY	+0.161	-0.006
FEEDBACK	+0.354	+0.364

READ AS ASSOCIATIONS ONLY

Cross-sectional, self-reported, small sample. No p-values were computed, so no coefficient is described as statistically significant. None of these values shows causation.

Highlighted: Skill Variety ↔ Job Satisfaction, r = +0.539, presented in the deck as r ≈ .54.